

Module 08: Planning — The Future Map

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Planning** is thinking about the future.
2. Learn about **Tools** we use to plan (Calendars, Clocks).
3. Know that planning helps us do fun things (like vacations!).

Introduction: The Time Travelers

Did you know you are a time traveler? Your brain can travel to **Tomorrow**! You can close your eyes and imagine what you will do.

- "Tomorrow I will go to the park." This is **Planning**. Without planning, we would miss birthdays, be late for school, and run out of food!

Key Concepts

1. The Calendar (The Map of Time)

A map shows us where places are. A calendar shows us where *events* are.

- Monday: School.
- Saturday: Soccer.
- December: Holidays. When we put something on the calendar, we are making a promise to our future selves.

2. The Schedule (The Order)

Planning is about **Order**.

- First: Socks.
- Then: Shoes. If you do it backward, it doesn't work! Families have a morning schedule (Wake up -> Brush Teeth -> Eat -> Go). Schedules reduce stress (Low Entropy!).

3. The Goal (The Treasure)

Why do we plan? To reach a **Goal**.

- Goal: Disneyland Trip.
- Plan: Save money, pack bags, drive car. Big fun requires big planning.

Activities

Activity 1: The Visual Schedule

Draw a comic strip of your morning.

1. Sun comes up.
2. Eat cereal.
3. Put on backpack.
4. Bus comes. Tape it to your door. Now you don't have to remember... the paper remembers for you!

Activity 2: The Weekend Wish

What do you want to do this weekend? Make a plan.

- **What:** Build a fort.
- **When:** Saturday at 2:00 PM.
- **Who:** Me and Dad.
- **Needs:** Blankets and pillows. If you plan it, it is more likely to happen!

Summary

Planning is how we turn our dreams into reality. By using calendars and schedules, the Family Brain organizes the future so we can have more fun and less rushing.

References

- *A Busy Year* by Leo Lionni

- *Pigs on a Blanket* (Fun with time)